

Oyster Herbals

Digital Commerce Platform

Business Process Improvement Analysis

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1 Executive Summary

1.1 Purpose of Process Analysis

The purpose of this Business Process Improvement Analysis is to evaluate existing operational workflows within Oyster Herbals and identify opportunities to improve efficiency, consistency, and customer service quality. The report examines current manual processes and proposes improvements enabled by the Digital Commerce Platform.

1.2 Business Context

Oyster Herbals operates as a clinic-based Ayurvedic wellness provider where product inquiries, ordering activities, pricing communication, and customer feedback collection are largely managed through manual interactions. While this approach supports personalized service, it limits scalability and creates operational inefficiencies.

1.3 Key Findings

- Significant administrative effort is spent handling routine customer inquiries.
- Manual order processing increases the likelihood of transcription errors.
- Product pricing updates are difficult to communicate consistently.
- Customer feedback is not systematically captured or utilized.
- Existing processes restrict the ability to serve a larger regional customer base.

2 Business Process Overview

2.1 Current Business Operations

The business currently relies on direct communication channels such as phone calls, WhatsApp conversations, and in-person visits. Most product-related interactions require manual staff involvement, including inquiries, order confirmation, pricing communication, and customer support activities.

2.2 Key Operational Activities

- Product inquiry handling.
- Order collection and fulfillment coordination.
- Customer communication and support.
- Product information and pricing management.
- Customer feedback collection.

2.3 Existing Process Landscape

The existing process landscape is highly dependent on staff availability and manual information sharing. Product information is maintained internally, customer inquiries are answered individually, and operational knowledge is distributed across employees rather than centralized systems.

3 Current State Process Assessment

3.1 Product Inquiry Process

Process Description

Customers contact the clinic through phone calls or messaging platforms to request product details, pricing information, ingredients, and availability status.

Current Challenges

- Staff must repeatedly answer similar questions.
- Customer responses depend on staff availability.
- Information access is limited outside operating hours.

Business Impact

High inquiry volumes consume administrative resources and reduce staff productivity.

3.2 Product Ordering Process

Process Description

Orders are collected manually through phone calls and messaging conversations. Customer names, delivery addresses, product selections, and payment information are recorded manually.

Current Challenges

- Manual transcription errors.
- Inconsistent order documentation.
- Increased order processing effort.

Business Impact

Operational inefficiencies increase processing time and can negatively affect customer satisfaction.

3.3 Customer Communication Process

Process Description

Order confirmations, delivery updates, payment instructions, and customer inquiries are managed manually through direct communication.

Current Challenges

- Delayed responses during busy periods.
- Repetitive communication tasks.
- Lack of communication standardization.

Business Impact

Increased communication workload and inconsistent customer experiences.

3.4 Product Information Management Process

Process Description

Product information, pricing, and availability details are updated manually and shared internally among staff members.

Current Challenges

- Pricing inconsistencies.
- Delayed information updates.
- Dependence on verbal communication.

Business Impact

Incorrect pricing communication may affect customer trust and operational accuracy.

4 Process Inefficiency Analysis

4.1 Inefficiency Identification Matrix

Process Area	Manual Activity	Bottleneck / Delay	Data Consistency Issue	Risk Rating
Product Inquiry	Staff manually provide product details and pricing over calls.	Customers wait during busy clinic hours.	Different staff may communicate inconsistent information.	High
Order Entry	Orders and addresses are recorded manually.	Verification and correction activities increase processing time.	Incorrect names, addresses, and product selections.	High
Price Updates	Price changes are communicated verbally.	Information reaches staff slowly.	Outdated prices may be quoted.	Medium
Feedback Collection	Customer feedback is captured informally.	Feedback cannot be reused efficiently.	No centralized customer review repository.	Medium

4.2 Key Process Challenges

- Excessive dependency on manual communication channels.
- Repeated handling of routine customer inquiries.
- Lack of centralized information management.

- Limited visibility into customer feedback trends.
- Difficulty scaling operations without increasing administrative workload.

5 Improvement Opportunities

5.1 Process Optimization Matrix

Opportunity	Current State	Proposed Improvement	Expected Benefit	Priority
Digital Product Catalog	Customers depend on staff for product information.	Provide a public online catalog with detailed product information.	Reduced inquiry volume and improved accessibility.	Critical
WhatsApp Ordering	Order details collected manually through calls.	Provide prefilled WhatsApp order initiation.	Reduced transcription errors and faster processing.	Critical
Centralized Product Management	Product information maintained through manual updates.	Implement administrative dashboard controls.	Improved accuracy and operational consistency.	Critical
Customer Review System	Feedback collected informally.	Create verified review and rating functionality.	Improved customer trust and social proof.	High
Search Capability	Customers manually browse products.	Introduce keyword search functionality.	Improved product discovery and customer experience.	High
Communication Templates	Staff write repetitive responses manually.	Use standardized communication templates.	Improved efficiency and communication consistency.	Medium

5.2 Improvement Prioritization

The highest-priority improvements focus on reducing administrative workload while improving customer accessibility. Digital product visibility, simplified ordering, and centralized information management provide the greatest immediate business value.

Secondary improvements concentrate on customer engagement, trust building, and communication optimization to support long-term growth and customer retention.

6 Future State Process Model

6.1 Optimized Process Workflows

Process Area	Current Manual Flow	Future Optimized Flow	Digital Capability
Product Inquiry	Customers contact staff for product information and pricing.	Customers access product details directly through the online catalog.	24/7 Product Catalog Access
Product Ordering	Orders are recorded manually through calls and messages.	Customers initiate orders through prefilled WhatsApp workflows.	WhatsApp Order Automation
Catalog Management	Product updates are communicated verbally among staff.	Administrators update product information centrally through the dashboard.	Centralized Administration Dashboard
Customer Feedback	Feedback is collected informally and often lost.	Customers submit ratings and reviews through authenticated accounts.	Review and Rating Management

6.2 Future State Benefits

- Faster customer access to product information.
- Improved order accuracy and fulfillment efficiency.
- Consistent pricing and catalog management.
- Structured customer feedback collection.
- Increased operational scalability.

7 Operational Impact Analysis

7.1 Customer Impact

Impact Area	Expected Outcome
Accessibility	Customers can access product information anytime without contacting staff.

Ordering Experience	Simplified purchasing process through WhatsApp integration.
Trust and Transparency	Verified reviews improve purchasing confidence.
Information Accuracy	Customers receive consistent product and pricing information.

7.2 Staff Impact

lightgray Impact Area	Expected Outcome
Inquiry Management	Reduction in repetitive customer inquiries.
Order Processing	Less manual data entry and verification effort.
Communication Efficiency	Improved consistency through standardized workflows.
Workload Distribution	More time available for patient care and operational activities.

7.3 Administrative Impact

lightgray Impact Area	Expected Outcome
Catalog Control	Centralized management of product information and pricing.
Data Accuracy	Reduced risk of inconsistent information.
Operational Visibility	Better oversight of products and customer interactions.
Process Standardization	Improved consistency across administrative activities.

7.4 Business Impact

lightgray Impact Area	Expected Outcome
Revenue Growth	Expanded reach beyond local geographic markets.
Operational Efficiency	Reduced manual workload and lower operational costs.

Customer Retention	Improved satisfaction and repeat purchase behavior.
Brand Credibility	Enhanced trust through professional digital presence and reviews.

8 Implementation Recommendations

8.1 Immediate Actions (Months 1–2)

- Deploy the digital product catalog and WhatsApp ordering functionality.
- Provide administrative dashboard access to authorized clinic staff.
- Standardize product information, pricing structures, and catalog descriptions.
- Promote the digital platform through clinic materials, prescriptions, and customer communications.

8.2 Mid-Term Actions (Months 3–4)

- Launch customer registration and review submission capabilities.
- Implement communication templates for order confirmations and payment instructions.
- Improve mobile browsing performance and accessibility.
- Establish review moderation and customer engagement processes.

8.3 Long-Term Actions (Months 5–6)

- Analyze customer ordering patterns and product demand trends.
- Implement advanced reporting and operational monitoring capabilities.
- Evaluate digital consultation and appointment booking opportunities.
- Explore customer loyalty and retention initiatives.

9 Success Metrics

9.1 Process Performance KPIs

Category	Metric	Current Baseline	Target	Data Source
Efficiency	Time spent answering product inquiries	2–3 hours daily	Below 1 hour daily	Staff Activity Logs

Efficiency	Average order processing time	15 minutes	Below 5 minutes	Order Records
Accuracy	Order entry errors	8% of orders	Below 1%	Fulfillment Reports
Accuracy	Pricing inconsistencies	5% occurrence rate	0% occurrence rate	Catalog Audits
Customer Satisfaction	Verified product reviews	0 online reviews	5+ reviews per core product	Review Database
Productivity	Catalog update completion time	Up to 24 hours	Below 5 minutes	Admin Dashboard Logs

9.2 Performance Monitoring Approach

Performance metrics should be reviewed monthly to evaluate operational improvements and customer experience outcomes. Regular monitoring ensures that process improvements remain aligned with business objectives and support continuous optimization initiatives.

10 Conclusion

10.1 Improvement Outcomes

The Business Process Improvement Analysis demonstrates that significant operational gains can be achieved through the introduction of a structured digital commerce platform. The proposed improvements reduce manual activities, eliminate common sources of error, and provide customers with more convenient access to products and information.

10.2 Business Benefits

The recommended process enhancements support improved operational efficiency, stronger customer engagement, better information accuracy, and increased scalability. By reducing administrative workload and standardizing key workflows, Oyster Herbals can allocate more resources toward customer care and business growth.

10.3 Strategic Value

The Digital Commerce Platform serves as a strategic enabler for long-term expansion by modernizing customer interactions while preserving the personalized service model that differentiates Oyster Herbals. The implementation of these improvements positions the organization for sustainable growth, stronger customer relationships, and improved operational performance.